

Building with AI

Classwork: Vibe Coding with Gemini Canvas

Name:

Date:

Today you'll build real apps and games just by describing them in plain English. Work through each part in order — start simple, then level up. Test as you go, and don't be afraid to ask Gemini to change things!

Part A — Warm-Up: Get Into Canvas (about 5 min)

Let's open the tool and make something quick.

1. Go to gemini.google.com and sign in with your class Google account.
2. Click the tools button (the + or pencil) and choose Canvas.
3. Type the starter prompt below, then press enter and wait while Gemini builds it.

Copy this prompt exactly:

Make a colorful "About Me" web card with my name, my 3 favorite things, and a fun background.

In one sentence, what did Gemini build?

Click Preview. Does it work when you click around? What do you see?

CONCEPT

You just vibe coded! You described what you wanted in plain words, and Gemini wrote the real code for you.

Part B — Peek Under the Hood (about 8 min)

Every web app is built from code. Let's go look at it.

1. In your Canvas project, switch from the Preview tab to the Code tab.
2. Scroll through. See if you can spot the three kinds of code: HTML, CSS, and JavaScript (JS).

Write down one word or line of code you recognize:

Which part do you think controls the COLORS — HTML, CSS, or JS?

CONCEPT

Think of it this way: HTML = the skeleton (the pieces), CSS = the skin & clothes (the look), JS = the brain & muscles (what it does).

Part C — Build a Game From a Prompt (about 10 min)

Start a NEW Canvas project, then copy this prompt exactly.

Copy this prompt exactly:

Make a simple game where I click falling stars to score points. Show my score at the top. The stars fall faster as my score goes up. Use a space background.

Play it in Preview. What was your high score?

Name one thing that works well:

Name one thing you would change:

Part D — The Refine Loop (about 10 min)

Real coders build, then improve. Make THREE changes to your game by describing them. After each, write the prompt you used and what changed.

Change A — change a color (example: "Make the stars gold and the background dark purple"). Your prompt:

What changed?

Change B — change the speed or difficulty. Your prompt:

What changed?

Change C — add something new (a restart button, a timer, or a sound). Your prompt:

What changed?

CONCEPT

Describing a problem and asking the AI to fix it is exactly what programmers call **DEBUGGING**. You're doing real computer science!

Part E — Make It Yours (about 12 min)

Pick ONE idea and build it your way: a quiz, flashcards, a mini-game, or an interactive story. Plan your prompt FIRST using the recipe, then build it.

Build a... (what type of app or game?)

that... (what does it do?)

It should have... (list 2-3 features)

Make it look... (colors, theme, style?)

Now write your FULL prompt here, then paste it into Canvas:

What happened? Did you have to refine it? Describe how it went:

Part F — Try Another Tool: Lovable (about 8 min)

Gemini Canvas isn't the only vibe-coding tool. Lovable is an app-builder website that pros use. Your teacher will help you sign in with your Google account.

HOW TO PROMPT

The app-builder recipe: "Build a [type of app] that [does what]. It should have [2-3 features]. Make it look [style]. It's for [who]." (AI Studio is another tool, but it's 18+ — just watch the teacher demo.)

1. Go to lovable.dev and sign in with your Google account.
2. You only get a few free builds a day, so plan ONE great prompt using the recipe above.

My app idea (one line):

My full Lovable prompt (use the recipe!):

How was building in Lovable different from Gemini Canvas?

Part G — Share & Reflect (about 5 min)

Show off your best creation, then reflect.

1. In Gemini Canvas, open your favorite project and get a shareable link.

Which project are you most proud of, and why?

If you had 30 more minutes, what would you add or change?

Rate today's class from 1 to 5, and tell us why: